

01. Role Definition & Requirements: Sr. SDET & Sr. Automation Engineer



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Purpose: Clear articulation of the job title, role, objective, scope, responsibilities, and prerequisites etc. for hiring Sr. SDET or Sr. Automation Engineer.

Sr. Software Development Engineer in Test (Sr. SDET)

Role Summary

A Sr. SDET is a developer-in-test responsible for designing scalable automation frameworks, integrating tests into CI/CD, and driving quality strategy within Agile teams. This role demands strong programming and architectural knowledge with a QA-first mindset.

Primary Objectives

- Architect and maintain reusable test automation frameworks.
- Enable CI/CD test integration and shift-left quality.
- Work closely with developers to ensure unit-to-system level quality.
- Drive test strategy across service layers (UI, API, DB, performance).
- Mentor junior QA engineers and perform peer code reviews.

Must-Have Skills & Qualifications

Area	Skillset / Tools
Programming	Java (OOPs, Collections, Exception Handling)
Framework Design	Built/Owned hybrid frameworks using Selenium + TestNG + Cucumber
API Testing	REST Assured, Postman, Swagger
Architecture	Test Pyramid, Microservices, SOA awareness
CI/CD & DevOps	Jenkins, GitHub/GitLab Pipelines, Maven/Gradle
DB Testing	Oracle, MySQL, strong SQL
Version Control	Git workflows, branch/PR/review process
Tools	JIRA, Confluence, Azure DevOps
Agile Methodology	Scrum ceremonies, user story QA grooming

Good-to-Have / Bonus Skills

- AWS / Docker / Kubernetes basics
- JMeter, Blazemeter (for perf testing)
- Security Testing awareness (SAST/DAST tools)
- Contract Testing (Pact, WireMock)
- Reporting tools (Allure, Extent Reports)

Preferred Traits

- Engineering-focused, clean coder with attention to detail
- Strong debugging and triage mindset
- Clear communicator with stakeholder engagement skills
- Collaborative across QA, Dev, DevOps
- Able to mentor junior SDETs or QA Engineers

Red Flags During Screening

- Only mentions using framework, not designing it
- No Git or CI/CD integration exposure

- Can't differentiate unit/integration/functional tests
- Weak Java/OOPs understanding
- Vague on real-world bug ownership or performance insight

Sr. Automation Engineer

Role Summary

A Sr. Automation Engineer focuses on implementing and maintaining automated test cases using existing frameworks across UI and API layers. The role emphasizes test coverage, execution stability, and continuous integration support.

Primary Objectives

- Automate regression and smoke suites for UI and API.
- Execute tests via CI tools like Jenkins.
- Maintain and update reusable functions in the automation framework.
- Report test results and collaborate with QA/Dev for defect validation.
- Document test evidence and scenario coverage.

Must-Have Skills & Qualifications

Area	Skillset / Tools
Automation Tools	Selenium WebDriver, TestNG, Cucumber
API Testing	Postman for manual API test + basics of automation
Version Control	Git (push/pull/branch)
CI/CD Execution	Jenkins pipeline usage, triggering jobs
Java Basics	Able to write test logic, loops, exception handling
Database Basics	Simple SQL queries, joins, count validation
Defect Tracking	JIRA (defect lifecycle, story traceability)
Agile Process	Standups, sprints, refinement sessions

Good-to-Have / Bonus Skills

- Basic RestAssured for API automation
- API chaining or data-driven API tests
- Exposure to Allure or Extent Reports
- Testing cloud-hosted applications (AWS, Azure)
- Working with qTest or TestRail for test case management

Preferred Traits

- Hands-on contributor with strong ownership mindset
- Reliable in test execution & result analysis
- Works well under sprint delivery model
- Clear and methodical test documentation
- Proactive in flagging risks or regression gaps

Red Flags During Screening

- Mentions using Selenium but no explanation of what/how
- Unable to describe how they run or debug failed tests
- Lacks CI/CD or version control exposure
- No API test exposure or Postman understanding
- Doesn't differentiate between test types or coverage